
Worksheet 6: CSS Syntax, Style Types, and Values

Background

In the student files you'll find a folder named **CA6-CSS** containing a starter page (`index.html`) and a **styles** subfolder. In this subfolder, you'll find with an almost-empty style sheet (`style.css`) and the normalize stylesheet (`modern-normalize.css`). Every rule you need to write in this activity uses only the element selectors and the two properties (`color` and `font-size`) that already appeared as worked examples in the Lecture 6 slides. The goal is to practise the mechanics, not to design a full page.

Instructions

Work through the tasks in order. Open `style.css` and `index.html` in your text editor. Open `index.html` in your browser. Refresh the page after each change to check the result. (**Note:** Remember to save your files after each change).

Task 1: Add your personal details

In `style.css`, add in your initials, surname and student number in the provided comment block at the top of the file.

Task 2: Write your first rule

In `style.css`, write a rule that selects the `h1` element and sets its `color` property to the Hex value `#0000ff`.

Task 3: Link the style sheet

In `index.html`, add a `<link>` element inside the `<head>` section that connects the page to `style.css`. Reload the page in your browser to confirm the heading colour changed (according to what you have done in Task 2).

Task 3: Colour notation

Change the `color` value from Task 2 two times: First change to `blue` and then to `rgb(0, 0, 255)`. Reload after each change. Confirm the heading looks the same each time. Then change back to the original Hex value from Task 2.

Task 4: Absolute vs relative length

In `style.css`, add a rule for `h2` that sets its `font-size`. First use an absolute unit (`pt` or `px`), reload, then change it to a relative unit (`em` or `rem`) and reload again. What did you observe when you resized the browser window or zoomed the page for each version?

Task 5: Style types and the cascade

Your `h1` rule in `style.css` is an external style. Now add the following, one step at a time, reloading after each:

1. In `index.html`, add an embedded `<style>` block inside `<head>` with an `h1 { color: #00ff00; }` rule. Reload the page. This colour should now win.
2. On the `<h1>` element itself, add an inline `style` attribute with a colour of `#ff0000`. Reload the page. This colour should now win over both the others.

Which style type won, and does that match the cascade order from the slides?

Task 6: Link the normalize style sheet

In `index.html`, add a `<link>` element inside the `<head>` section that connects the page to `modern-normalize.css`. (**Note:** This link must be added **BEFORE** the link to `style.css`). Reload the page in your browser to observe the difference in how the page is rendered.

Task 7: Validate

Open the W3C CSS Validator (<https://jigsaw.w3.org/css-validator/>) and check `style.css` by direct input. Fix any errors it reports.

If you finish early

Try adding a rule for the `ul` or `li` element using a `color` or `font-size` property and see whether it behaves as you expect.
